

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp

WEDNESDAY, DECEMBER 17, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 143

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 48114.26 ▼ 302.30 0.62% NASDAQ 23111.46 ▲ 0.2% STOXX 600 579.80 ▼ 0.5% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 9/32, yield 4.148% OIL \$55.27 ▼ \$1.55 GOLD \$4,304.50 ▼ \$2.20 EURO \$1.1749 YEN 154.72

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **The U.S. unemployment rate** rose to 4.6% in November, its highest in more than four years, fueling questions about the underlying strength of the economy. **A1**
- ◆ **Trump was set to interview** Christopher Waller, a Fed governor, as another candidate to lead the central bank. **A2**
- ◆ **Warner Bros. Discovery** is preparing to tell its shareholders to reject Paramount's latest offer as soon as Wednesday and plans to recommend they support its deal with Netflix instead. **B1**
- ◆ **Major U.S. stock indexes** ended mixed, with the S&P 500 and Dow retreating 0.2% and 0.6%, respectively, and the Nasdaq rising 0.2%. **B12**
- ◆ **Kraft Heinz said** Steve Cahillane will become its chief executive on Jan. 1, succeeding Carlos Abrams-Rivera, in a shake-up that comes months after the company said it would split in two. **B1**
- ◆ **Blackstone is leading** a \$400 million investment in data-security firm Cyera that values the New York-based company at \$9 billion. **B7**
- ◆ **PepsiCo sought to** push up prices of soda and other goods at retailers to help Walmart, regulators alleged in a lawsuit that the Trump administration dismissed. **B1**
- ◆ **Tesla was given** 90 days to change its ad policies after California found it deceived consumers with claims about its self-driving tech. **B2**
- ◆ **British streaming company** DAZN is in advanced talks to acquire a majority stake in the regional U.S. sports broadcaster Main Street Sports. **B3**

World-Wide

- ◆ **Trump's push to** loosen Beijing's influence in the Panama Canal was set back by a demand from China that its largest shipping company get a controlling stake in a deal to sell dozens of ports to a group led by BlackRock. **A1**
- ◆ **Senate GOP leader** Thune said Congress won't be able to extend health-insurance subsidies before leaving for the holidays, ending hopes for a last-minute deal and punting any possible fix into 2026. **A3**
- ◆ **Trump ordered** a blockade on sanctioned oil tankers entering and leaving Venezuela in an escalation of the U.S. pressure campaign on Maduro. **A7**
- ◆ **Nick Reiner was** charged with first-degree murder in the killing of his parents, Rob Reiner and Michele Singer Reiner. **A3**
- ◆ **White House chief** of staff Susie Wiles gave candid assessments of Trump's top aides and the president's operating style in interviews for Vanity Fair. **A4**
- ◆ **Police released new** videos of the suspected gunman responsible for Saturday's shooting at Brown University as the manhunt entered its fourth day. **A3**
- ◆ **The Pentagon won't** release the full, unedited video of a lethal Sept. 2 boat strike, Hegseth said, despite bipartisan calls to do so. **A7**
- ◆ **The Trump administration** expanded its travel ban to cover five additional countries and imposed new partial bans on 15 others. **A3**
- ◆ **Died: Joe Ely**, 78, influential singer-songwriter. **A4**

CONTENTS		Opinion.....	A13-15
Arts in Review....	A12	Personal Journal	A10-11
Business & Finance...	B2	Property Report...	B6
Crossword.....	A11	Sports.....	A16
Heard on Street... B13		Tech & Media.....	B4
Markets.....	B12	U.S. News.....	A2-6
Markets Digest.....	B9	World News.....	A7-9



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved

Unemployment Rises Despite Job Gains

Rate of 4.6%, highest in over four years, hints at underlying economic weakness

The U.S. unemployment rate rose to 4.6% in November, its highest in more than four years, fueling questions about the economy's underlying strength.

By Chao Deng, Harriet Torry and Justin Lahart

A delayed government report on Tuesday showed that 64,000 jobs were gained in November, while 105,000 jobs were lost in October. Job

losses in June, August and October mean the U.S. economy has shed jobs in three out of the past six months.

The unemployment rate in November was up from 4.4% in September, the last month the Labor Department reported for that metric.

Taken together, the data point to one of the weakest American labor markets in years. While the economy has added jobs so far this year, mostly on the back of gains in healthcare and education, the shock of shifting trade policies and an immigration crackdown has restrained labor demand and supply, making for tepid hiring overall.

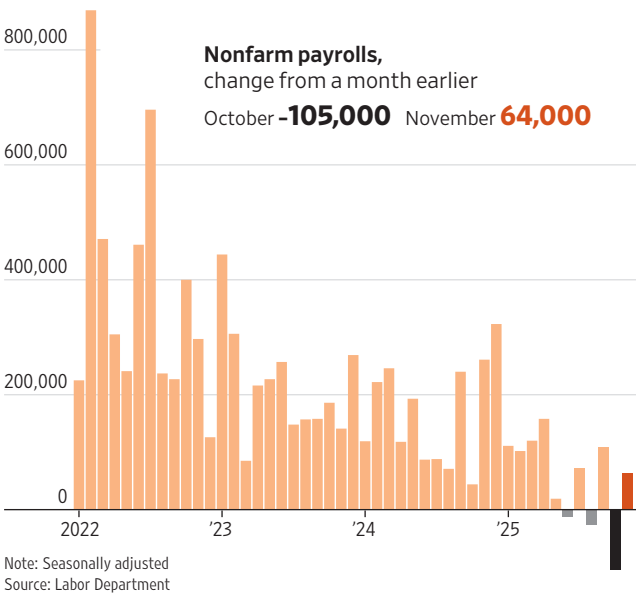
"All roads lead back to policy out of Washington, D.C.,"

said Joseph Brusuelas, chief economist at accounting firm RSM. "I'm not saying this is a harbinger of a recession, but we have some real challenges to the economy that we didn't have one year ago."

Still, market reaction was muted Tuesday. The Dow Jones Industrial Average fell 302 points, or 0.6%, and the S&P 500 declined 0.2%. The Nasdaq Composite rose 0.2%.

Some economists and investors were putting less stock in the new job numbers because of likely distortions from the long government closure, which prevented the Labor Department from collecting some of the data that it normally would have.

Please turn to page A2



Australians Pay Tearful Tribute to Jewish Victims



HEARTBREAK: The parents of 10-year-old Matilda Britvan, one of the 15 people killed in a shooting that targeted a Hanukkah celebration Sunday, mourn at a vigil for the victims in Sydney on Tuesday. The attack has shaken up a tightknit community. **A8**

CEOs Are Learning to Make the Most Of Trump's Turn to State Capitalism

Some have figured out how to take advantage of the expanded government presence

By GREG IP

Last week Nvidia finally got permission to sell one of its most advanced semiconductor chips to China. The catch: The federal government will take 25% of the revenue from those sales.

The Nvidia deal says something important about the relationship between business and government under President Trump. His regular intrusions into the boardroom—taking equity stakes, revenue slices or a “golden share”; prodding companies to lower prices or sell drugs through a federal website—are a

sort of state capitalism, in which the state doesn't necessarily own companies, but uses its substantial leverage to steer their behavior.

State capitalism is a two-way street. Many businesses, by aligning themselves with Trump's agenda, elicit better treatment—in their ability to sell to China, the tariffs they pay, how they are regulated, and what mergers are allowed. In other words, state capitalism doesn't just serve the interests of the state, but of favored capitalists.

Nvidia is, in effect, paying for a license that used to be free, but it hasn't

objected. After all, it's getting access to a lucrative market that would otherwise be off-limits. In August, shortly after Trump first proposed a 15% cut, chief executive Jensen Huang told an interviewer: “Whatever it takes to get it approved for us to be able to sell in China, is fine with us.”

State capitalism is neither socialism, in which the government owns the means of production, or laissez-faire capitalism. It's more of a hybrid, vari-

Please turn to page A9

◆ Tim Higgins: AI order stirs skirmish... **B7**

CoreWeave Struggles Highlight Fears of AI Bubble

By ROBBIE WHELAN

CoreWeave, the largest of a new breed of companies driving the artificial-intelligence boom, has watched more than \$34 billion of value vaporize in six weeks.

The share-price plunge of 48% comes as investors worry about a possible AI bubble, the fallout from a failed merger and public criticism from high-profile short seller Jim Chanos, known for predicting the collapse of Enron.

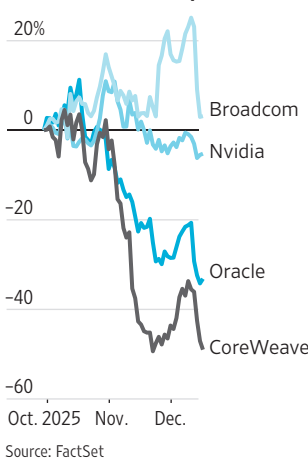
But some of the high-tech company's biggest problems began with a very low-tech nuisance: unexpectedly turbulent rainstorms in North Texas.

Over the summer, heavy rains and winds caused a roughly 60-day delay at a construction site in Denton, a small city north of Dallas, preventing contractors from pouring concrete for a major AI data-center complex, according to people familiar with the matter.

As a result, the completion

Please turn to page A6

Share-price performance since the end of September



When Mom Takes Charge Of Dating

* * *
Frustrated singles cede control. It's a gamble.

By KELLY CLOONAN

After their weekly Sunday dinners, members of the Allen family gather in front of the TV. There's booing, shouting and frequent shaking of heads. Occasionally everyone cheers.

They aren't watching football. They're swiping through Danielle Allen's Bumble. Most people try to keep their families out of their relationship business. But some singles, burned out by fruitless searches for love, are handing control of their dating profiles to the people who keep asking why they aren't having any luck.

Please turn to page A11

China's Terms Threaten Deal for Panama Ports

By COSTAS PARIS

President Trump's push to loosen China's influence in the Panama Canal has hit a wall now that Beijing is demanding that China's largest shipping company get a controlling stake in a deal to sell dozens of ports to a BlackRock-led group.

The proposed sale includes two ports at the Panama Canal and more than 40 others around the world, all controlled by Hong Kong-based CK Hutchison. BlackRock and container operator Mediterranean Shipping reached a \$22.8 billion agreement in March to buy them after Trump raised security concerns about Hutchison's—and the ports'—connection to China.

That deal angered Beijing and, after initially pushing for China's Cosco to be brought in as an equal partner, it has

now upped its demands, people familiar with the talks said. China is threatening to block the deal unless Cosco gets a majority stake, they say.

BlackRock and MSC had been open to offering Cosco an equal stake, but the demand for majority control and veto rights in running the ports is unacceptable, those people say. The White House signaled on Monday that it, too, wouldn't accept such conditions.

"The President has made clear that Chinese control of the Panama Canal is unacceptable, violates the U.S.-Panama Treaty, and jeopardizes our national and economic security," a White House official said.

The deal is now at an intractable impasse, people involved in the talks say. A senior Chinese official said

Please turn to page A7

salesforce

What if you could empower every employee with a limitless, digital workforce?

You can with Agentforce.

Find out how at agentforce.com.